Summary of Teaching Evaluations

Judhajit Chakraborty

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Courses Taught

AFRE 203: Data Analysis for the Agri-Food System, Spring (In-Person) & Summer (Online), 2022

AFRE 303: Managerial Economics, Spring (In-Person) & Summer (Online), 2023 ; & Summer (Online), 2024

Highlights

- **AFRE 203, Spring 2022:** 85% of students rated my concern with whether students learned the material, and their opportunity to ask questions, as *superior* or *above average*.
- **AFRE 203, Spring 2022:** 85% rated the improvement in their competence due to the course as *superior* or *above average*; 88% said the same of the contribution of homework to their understanding.
- **AFRE 203, Summer 2022:** every respondent rated every instructor item *superior* or *above average* (mean of 1.33 in all four categories).
- **AFRE 303, Summer 2024:** students agreed that assignments and tests let them demonstrate their understanding (4.60/5) and that the course expanded their understanding of the subject (4.40/5).
- **AFRE 303, Summer 2023 to Summer 2024:** the mean SPLS score rose from 3.91 to 4.24, with the largest gains in course organization (3.43 to 4.00) and demonstrating understanding (4.00 to 4.60).

Summary of Evaluations

The following table presents a summary of student evaluations for Data Analysis for the Agri-Food System, Spring & Summer, 2022 and Managerial Economics, Spring, 2023.

Table 1: Student Instructional Rating System (SIRS) Scores

1 = superior, 2 = above average, 3 = average, 4 = below average, 5 = inferior

	AFRE 203 Spring 2022	AFRE 203 Summer 2022	AFRE 303[a] Spring 2023	Category Mean
Instructor Involvement	1.85	1.33	2.18	1.79
Student Instructor Interaction	1.86	1.33	2.33	1.84
Course Demands	1.90	1.33	2.30	1.84
Course Organization	1.98	1.33	2.65	1.99
Mean	**1.898**	**1.330**	**2.365**	**1.864**
Responses / Enrolled	33 / 68	6 / 9	23 / 53	

[a] I co-instructed this course with Professor Rudi Polloshka (50% responsibility). All other courses involved 100% responsibility. Average scores are across all questions in each category.

Table 2: Selected Item-Level SIRS Results, AFRE 203 (Spring 2022)

1 = superior, 2 = above average, 3 = average, 4 = below average, 5 = inferior

Item	Mean	% Superior or Above Average
Instructor's concern with whether students learned the material	1.54	85%
Students' opportunity to ask questions	1.66	85%
Improvement in competence in this area due to this course	1.75	85%
Contribution of homework to understanding, relative to time	1.75	88%
Instructor's interest in teaching	1.78	73%
Course organization	1.78	78%

Table 3: Student Perceptions of Learning Survey (SPLS) Scores

1 = strongly disagree, 2 = disagree, 3 = neutral, 4 = agree, 5 = strongly agree

	AFRE 303 Summer 2023	AFRE 303 Summer 2024
Expectations: Students understood what was expected	4.00	4.00
Organization: Course was well organized	3.43	4.00
Atmosphere: Instructor created an atmosphere that supported learning	4.14	4.20
Expanded understanding	4.00	4.40
Demonstrate understanding	4.00	4.60
Mean	**3.914**	**4.240**
Responses / Enrolled	8 / 18	5 / 17

Starting Summer 2023, MSU replaced SIRS with the Student Perceptions of Learning Survey (SPLS). Therefore, for Managerial Economics, Summer 2023 & 2024, I present a summary based on the new evaluation system.

Selected Student Comments

Comments are quoted as written.

> *"This course was one of the most well-organized courses i have taken and the instructor was very caring and interested in the students sucess."*
>
> — AFRE 203, Spring 2022 (SIRS)

> *"No comment, this is the perfect class."*
>
> — AFRE 203, Spring 2022 (SIRS)

> *"Professor Chakraborty was very accommodating to numerous instances for me in this course. Although I found the schedule and material quite hard to follow time wise in the first half of the class, the second half was very well laid out and easy to keep track of especially since the dates administered and due dates were given for every assignment after the midterm until the end of class. I found I learned quite alot in this class and I am very happy to have Professor Chakraborty as an instructor."*
>
> — AFRE 303, Summer 2024 (SPLS)

> *"He was very organized and understanding of students schedules. He graded timely."*
>
> — AFRE 303, Summer 2024 (SPLS)

> *"… thank you for your help this semester, it has been a difficult semester and you have by far surpassed other professors in being helpful and understanding. From the bottom of my heart thank you for being a great professor. In my four years at State, you will always be one of my favorite professors. I will make sure to refer my younger siblings attending MSU."*
>
> — Unsolicited email from a student (name withheld)